

SHAHIDH SALIHEEN

Urban Planner | GIS & Spatial Analyst | Research & Data Analyst

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📍 Colombo, Sri Lanka

📁 [Portfolio](#)



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Urban Planning graduate with a BSc (Hons) in Urban Informatics and Planning from the University of Moratuwa, maintaining First Class standing with a CGPA of 3.81. Possessing a strong foundation in urban and regional planning, development planning, land-use planning, urban design, heritage conservation, and planning research. Experienced in contributing to municipal, infrastructure, heritage, and land development projects through planning studies, site assessments, spatial analysis, and evidence-based decision-making. Demonstrated ability to prepare development proposals, planning recommendations, technical reports, and strategic interventions that support sustainable and inclusive urban development. Skilled in integrating planning principles, policy considerations, and geospatial analysis to address complex urban challenges while working effectively within multidisciplinary teams. Committed to promoting well-planned, resilient, and people-centered urban environments through innovative and sustainable planning practices.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) in Urban Informatics and Planning

April 2022 – May 2026

University of Moratuwa

- CGPA: 3.81
- Dean's List: L1S1, L1S2, L2S3, L3S5, L4S7

Certificate in Foundations of Project Management

Dec 2025

- University of Moratuwa

Certificate in Project Scope and Schedule Management

Jan 2026

- University of Moratuwa

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ASSISTANT PROJECT MANAGER - EML Consultants PLC

Mar – Jun 2026

- Coordinated project activities, schedules, deliverables, and stakeholder communications across multiple consultancy assignments, ensuring effective project implementation and timely delivery.
- Developed project monitoring and tracking dashboards to support project management functions, enabling systematic monitoring of project progress, milestones, and performance indicators.
- Conducted research, data analysis, and technical assessments for urban planning, environmental planning, and development-related projects to support evidence-based decision-making.
- Assisted in the preparation of technical reports, project documentation, presentations, and progress updates for clients and project teams.
- Collaborated with multidisciplinary teams to manage project information, monitor implementation progress, and support project planning and reporting activities.
- Supported the coordination of project workflows, documentation management, and compliance with project requirements throughout the project lifecycle.

ASSISTANT - RESEARCH & BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT - Global GIS (Pvt) Ltd

Sep – Dec 2025

- Supported municipal, infrastructure, heritage conservation, and land development projects through GIS-based spatial analysis and planning-related assessments.
- Conducted land-use analysis, accessibility assessments, terrain evaluations, and site suitability studies to support planning and development decision-making.
- Prepared GIS maps, spatial datasets, technical reports, and project documentation for public and private sector clients.
- Collaborated with GIS specialists, surveyors, planners, and technical teams to deliver project outputs within established timelines.
- Participated in drone surveys, GNSS-based data collection, and field investigations supporting planning and infrastructure projects.

INTERN - RESEARCH & BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT - Global GIS (Pvt) Ltd

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Assisted in municipal planning, land development, infrastructure, and heritage-related projects by supporting GIS-based spatial analysis, field investigations, and planning assessments.
- Participated in UAV (drone) surveys, GNSS data collection, and photogrammetric processing to generate orthomosaics, Digital Elevation Models (DEM), contour maps, and terrain models for planning and engineering applications.
- Supported the preparation of GIS maps, technical reports, spatial datasets, and project documentation through land-use analysis, site assessments, and geospatial data interpretation.
- Contributed to planning research, proposal development, and business development activities by conducting data analysis, preparing technical presentations, and collaborating with multidisciplinary project teams.

ARCHITECTURAL ASSISTANT - AIDA Design Studio

Apr 2025 – Oct 2025

- Assisted in preparing architectural drawings, site layouts, and spatial development concepts for residential and commercial projects.
- Developed AutoCAD drawings, SketchUp models, and visualization materials to support design development and client presentations.
- Supported design reviews by considering site constraints, accessibility requirements, land-use compatibility, and planning considerations.
- Coordinated with architects and design teams during project development stages to ensure alignment between planning and design objectives.
- Assisted in the preparation of project documentation, design revisions, and presentation materials throughout the design process.

FREELANCE DESIGNER – URBAN DEVELOPMENT & DESIGN PROJECT

Jan 2023 – Present

- Prepared conceptual urban design and development proposals for public space enhancement, heritage-led regeneration, and mixed-use development projects.
- Conducted site analysis, land-use assessments, and spatial planning evaluations to identify development opportunities and support design decision-making.
- Developed masterplans, site layouts, urban design concepts, and 3D visualizations using AutoCAD, SketchUp, and rendering tools.
- Contributed to a coastal public space development proposal focused on improving public accessibility, recreational opportunities, and local economic activities.
- Prepared a heritage-sensitive regeneration proposal for the Bogambara Prison precinct, integrating adaptive reuse, public space development, tourism potential, and heritage conservation principles.

Freelance Transcriber (Tamil to English)

Oct 2023 & Nov 2024

- Transcribed Tamil audio recordings into English, ensuring accuracy and cultural context for clear understanding.
- Completed projects efficiently and met client specifications, enhancing skills in bilingual transcription and translation.
- Skills: Transcription, translation, language proficiency (Tamil & English), attention to detail.

PROJECTS

INDUSTRY PROJECTS - GLOBAL GIS (PVT) LTD

Madampitiya Waste Landfill Site Survey and Volume Assessment

May 2025

Client: Colombo Municipal Council

Role: Assistant GIS & Spatial Analyst

- Participated in UAV photogrammetry and GNSS-based field data collection activities.
- Assisted in generating Digital Elevation Models (DEM), contour maps, terrain models, and 3D surface models.
- Supported waste volume calculations and spatial analysis using 3D Survey software.
- Contributed to technical reporting and spatial outputs for the proposed Organic Waste Biogasification Plant project.

Aaviyana Private Chalet Site Topographic Survey and Terrain Analysis

May – Jun 2025

Role: Assistant GIS & Spatial Analyst

- Participated in UAV photogrammetric surveys and GNSS-based field data collection.
- Assisted in producing contour maps, terrain models, and topographic datasets for site planning purposes.
- Conducted spatial analysis supporting site evaluation and development planning requirements.
- Contributed to project mapping outputs and technical documentation.

Ramba Rajamaha Vihara Archaeological Site Survey and Monument Mapping

July – Aug 2025

Role: GIS & Spatial Analyst

- Assisted in land-use mapping and archaeological monument location mapping using GIS and GNSS technologies.
- Supported spatial data collection and site survey activities within a heritage conservation context.
- Prepared thematic maps, spatial datasets, and survey documentation of the project.
- Assisted in spatial analysis supporting heritage documentation and conservation planning.

UAV-Assisted Aerial Survey and LiDAR Mapping for Mining Operations, Trincomalee

July – Aug 2025

Role: GIS & Spatial Analyst

- Supported UAV and LiDAR-based spatial data collection and processing activities.
- Conducted terrain modelling, contour generation, and topographic analysis for mining operations.
- Prepared GIS datasets, analytical outputs, and technical reports.
- Supported site assessment activities through spatial analysis and mapping.

Norochcholai Power Plant Site Survey and Terrain Assessment

Sep 2025

Role: GIS & Spatial Analysis Assistant

- Participated in UAV and GNSS-based site surveys supporting infrastructure-related assessments.
- Conducted terrain analysis, contour generation, and spatial data processing activities.
- Conducted volume calculations, site condition assessments, and technical mapping activities.
- Prepared GIS datasets, analytical reports, and project documentation.

SELECTED PLANNING & RESEARCH PROJECTS

Pettah Urban Regeneration Project, Colombo

Jan 2026 – May 2026

(Individually Supervised Site Planning & Design Project)

- Developed a heritage-led urban regeneration proposal for the Old Town Hall and Market Precinct in Pettah, focusing on heritage conservation, economic revitalization, and public realm enhancement.
- Conducted detailed site investigations including land-use analysis, pedestrian movement studies, accessibility assessments, urban morphology analysis, and stakeholder observations to identify existing challenges and opportunities.
- Applied urban design, place-making, and heritage conservation principles to evaluate spatial conflicts, underutilized spaces, circulation patterns, and development pressures within the study area.
- Proposed a pedestrian-oriented market spine integrating informal vendor management, multimodal mobility improvements, adaptive reuse strategies, public open spaces, and enhanced streetscape design.
- Prepared masterplans, urban design guidelines, implementation strategies, financial feasibility assessments, and PPP-based development frameworks to support long-term project sustainability and urban revitalization.

Night Time Food Culture Development Study, Colombo

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

(Individually Supervised Research Project – Undergraduate Research)

- Investigated the spatial, social, and economic dynamics of emerging night-time food activity nodes within the Colombo Municipal Council area and their implications for urban planning and local economic development.
- Designed and implemented field surveys, stakeholder interviews, and observational studies to collect primary data on user behaviour, accessibility patterns, operational characteristics, and spatial distribution of food culture nodes.
- Developed a spatial database integrating land-use information, transportation accessibility, economic indicators, and socio-spatial characteristics to support comprehensive analysis.
- Applied advanced spatial analytical techniques including Logistic Regression, Geographically Weighted Regression (GWR), and Spatial Coupling Coordination Model (SCCM) to identify location determinants, clustering behaviour, and development potential.
- Produced evidence-based planning recommendations aimed at improving accessibility, safety, governance mechanisms, economic opportunities, and sustainable management of night-time urban activities.

Traffic Monitoring and Decision-Support System using Computer Vision

Jan 2025

- Developed an automated traffic monitoring and decision-support system to support evidence-based transport planning, infrastructure management, and urban mobility analysis through real-time traffic observations.
- Designed a workflow integrating computer vision, database management, and dashboard visualization to collect, process, store, and analyse pedestrian and vehicle movement data from street-level video footage.
- Applied a YOLO-based object detection model and Python-based processing framework to identify, classify, and quantify vehicles and pedestrians, generating time-series traffic data for continuous monitoring.
- Developed an SQL database and interactive dashboard environment to manage historical and real-time traffic information, enabling trend analysis, traffic pattern assessment, and infrastructure performance evaluation.
- Produced a scalable analytical framework capable of supporting planning decisions related to road capacity management, congestion monitoring, traffic operations, pedestrian movement analysis, and urban mobility planning.

Heritage Development Planning Proposal, Nuwara Eliya

Jan – Mar 2025

- Developed a heritage sensitive planning framework balancing conservation priorities with future urban development requirements within the Nuwara Eliya urban area.
- Conducted heritage resource assessments, land-use analysis, and spatial investigations to identify conservation sensitive zones and development opportunity areas.
- Applied GIS-based spatial analysis and Multi-Criteria Decision Making (MCDM) techniques to evaluate development suitability while protecting heritage assets and cultural landscapes.
- Formulated planning and urban design guidelines addressing development control, heritage preservation, land-use compatibility, and place-making objectives.
- Prepared suitability maps, spatial plans, and strategic recommendations promoting sustainable heritage management, tourism enhancement, and context-sensitive urban development.

Regional Planning Project – Human–Elephant Conflict (HEC), Sri Lanka

Sep – Oct 2024

- Conducted a comprehensive assessment of the socio-economic, spatial, and environmental dimensions of human–elephant conflict by analysing settlement patterns, livelihood activities, community perceptions, land-use dynamics, and conflict distribution across affected regions.
- Evaluated existing national and regional planning frameworks, including the National Physical Planning Policy, to assess the extent to which human–elephant conflict considerations were integrated into long-term development planning and infrastructure proposals.
- Applied GIS-based spatial analysis to identify conflict hotspots, elephant movement corridors, settlement vulnerabilities, proposed development pressures, and environmentally sensitive areas requiring planning interventions.
- Developed a modified National Physical Plan by reviewing proposed development projects, re-evaluating urban hierarchy structures, recommending alternative development strategies, and proposing zoning, settlement planning, and environmental management measures to minimise conflict risks.
- Produced policy recommendations, conflict-risk maps, spatial planning proposals, and development control strategies aimed at balancing ecological conservation, community livelihoods, regional development objectives, and long-term sustainability.

Local Plan for Trincomalee Municipal Council Area

Jan – Mar 2024

- Prepared a development-oriented local plan aimed at promoting tourism-led economic growth, public space enhancement, and community-based urban development within the Trincomalee Municipal Council area.
- Conducted land-use surveys, accessibility assessments, and spatial inventory mapping to identify existing development patterns, opportunities, and constraints.
- Applied GIS-based spatial analysis to evaluate tourism potential, connectivity, public facility distribution, and suitability for future development interventions.
- Developed spatial planning strategies focusing on tourism development, public realm improvements, recreational spaces, and local economic activation while considering environmental and community needs.
- Produced development proposals, planning maps, zoning recommendations, and strategic interventions to support sustainable urban growth and long-term municipal development.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Urban & Regional Planning

- Development Planning
- Local Planning
- Regional Planning
- Land Use Planning
- Environmental Planning
- Urban Design and Regeneration
- Heritage Conservation Planning
- Infrastructure Planning

Spatial Analysis & GIS

- GIS Mapping and Spatial Analysis
- Site Suitability Assessment
- Accessibility Analysis
- Remote Sensing Applications
- Spatial Modelling
- Terrain and Topographic Analysis
- Geospatial Data Management

Research & Policy Analysis

- Planning Research
- Quantitative and Qualitative Analysis
- Socio-Economic Analysis
- Policy Review and Evaluation
- Evidence-Based Decision Making
- Technical Report Writing
- Survey Design and Data Collection

Leadership & Professional Skills

- Teamwork & Leadership
- Time Management and Organisation
- Professional Reporting and Documentation
- Project Coordination
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Project Monitoring and Reporting
- Documentation Management
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Presentation Development
- Problem Solving and Analytical Thinking

EXPERTISE

- **Productivity Tools:** Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Nvivo
- **Collaboration & Documentation Tools:** Microsoft SharePoint, Google Documents, Canva
- **GIS & Spatial Analysis :** QGIS, ArcMap, ArcGIS Pro, AutoCAD, AutoCAD Civil 3D, SketchUp, Enscape,GEE
- **Technical & Surveying Tools:** GNSS/GPS, 3D Survey, PIX4D, Advance GIS Analysis & LiDAR data processing
- **Data Analysis & Statistics:** R, Python (basic), SPSS, Microsoft Excel

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- **Student Member** – Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka *Present*
- **Batch Representative** – Semester 8 T&CP 21st Batch *2026*
- **Batch Representative** – Majlis-UI-Islam, University of Moratuwa *2022 – 2026*
- **Translator** – Town & Country Planning Students’ Society *2024 – 2025*

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Award-winning participant** in provincial and national speech competitions, including **multiple 1st Place achievements** at the provincial level. *2013 –2015*
- **Received recognition** in multiple inter-school debate competitions. *2015 – 2017*
- **Developed strong public speaking, communication, and critical thinking** skills through competitive speaking and debating.
- **Captain** – Football Team (School) *2014 – 2015*

LANGUAGES

Tamil: **Native** Sinhala: **Proficient** English: **Proficient**

REFERENCES

Dr. Rizvi Noordeen (PhD, UK) • Head of the Department, Senior Lecturer • Department of Town & Country Planning, University of Moratuwa • Tel: +94 77 220 2336 • Email: nmrizvi@uom.lk	Plnr.Y. Arthy • Assistant Director (Town Planning) • Urban Development Authority, Battaramulla. • Tel: +94 77 496 0221 • Email: arthy156@gmail.com
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